

Request Number: 2026-ICFO-18943
Submission Date: 3/01/2026
Agency: Department of Homeland Security
Component: US Immigrations & Customs Enforcement
Processing Track: Simple
Status: Awaiting Agency Review
Request Description:

Pursuant to 5 U.S.C. § 552, I request all records related to ICE's due diligence on the warehouse at 16220 Wright Road, Williamsport, MD, specifically: - Environmental reviews and assessments (including any Phase I/II ESAs); - Safety inspections and reports; - Any lease, acquisition, or occupancy evaluation documents; - All correspondence, communications, or coordination between DHS or ICE and Washington County, Maryland (including the County Commissioners, County Administrator, or any county agency) regarding the property, its suitability, or intended use. Please search ERO, facilities/real property offices, and any DHS/ICE offices involved in intergovernmental coordination. Provide records in electronic format. If any portion is withheld, identify the exemption and release all segregable material. I request expedited processing. No anticipated fees should exceed \$25 without prior notice to me.

Fee Waiver Status: Pending Decision

Fee Waiver Justification:

I request a full waiver of all fees pursuant to 5 U.S.C. § 552(a)(4)(A)(iii). I am a journalist with Project Salt Box, a media organization engaged in public interest reporting on government accountability. The records requested will be used solely to inform public reporting and community advocacy regarding ICE's site selection and due diligence practices — not for any commercial purpose. Disclosure will contribute significantly to public understanding of how federal agencies evaluate and coordinate with local governments on facility siting decisions, including whether adequate environmental and safety reviews were conducted to protect the health of surrounding communities. There is no commercial interest in this request.

Expedited Processing Status: Pending Decision

Expedited Processing Justification:

I request expedited processing pursuant to 5 U.S.C. § 552(a)(6)(E) and 6 C.F.R. § 5.5(d). There is a compelling need for these records on multiple grounds. First, the facility at 16220 Wright Road is reported to become operational as early as Spring 2026, leaving an extremely narrow window for meaningful public scrutiny. Second, DHS has only recently opened public

comment on floodplain activity at this site, yet no local communities or organizations have been designated as consulting parties under the National Environmental Policy Act (NEPA) — raising urgent questions about whether legally required environmental review and community consultation have been properly conducted. Third, as a journalist with Project Salt Box, I have a compelling need to inform the public about actual or alleged federal activity that, if left unexamined, may result in irreversible harm to the surrounding community's health, safety, and legal rights under NEPA. The public's ability to participate meaningfully in the NEPA process will be foreclosed entirely if these records are not processed before the facility becomes operational. I certify that the foregoing is true and correct to the best of my knowledge, as required by 6 C.F.R. § 5.5(d)(3).